

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 3

♥ 9 2

♦ A Q 10 4

♣ A J 7 3

♠ A K J 8 6 2

♥ K 7 4

♦ 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ 7 5

♥ Q J 10 8 5 3

♦ K J 7

♣ 10 9

♠ Q 4

♥ A 6

♦ 9 8 6 5 3

♣ Q 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♥Q

West's ♥9 looks a little ominous, particularly since East apparently has some length in the suit. Presumably you played the ♥A on the first trick. Next lead the ♥6 from dummy, hoping West can't (or doesn't) ruff. He plays the ♥2. Win the ♥K and play your ♥4, ruffing with dummy's ♠Q. West is out of ♥s, but can't over-ruff. Now pull trumps and set up one ♣ trick. You lose 2 ♣s and a ♦, just as expected.

Ruffing with the ♠Q might cost a trick if the ♠s split 4-1 and West did not have a doubleton ♥. But you need to stay flexible and make your decisions based on what you see happening at the table. In this deal, after West signalled high-low in ♥s it was logical to play him for a doubleton.

An easy one. You bid 1♠. Partner responds 1NT.

What is your next bid?

You're going to rebid your 6-card ♠ suit, but how high? The usual guideline is to bid 2♠ with 13-15 points, but jump to 3♠ with 16-18 points. You come in just over the line so you bid 3♠. Partner puts it in game.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q, West playing ♥9.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q, West playing ♥9.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You must eliminate one loser and the easiest one will be the ♥ which you can ruff in dummy. However,

Board 2

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5
 ♥ 8 4
 ♦ A K Q J 5 4
 ♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 7 4 3
 ♥ A K 6 3
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ A K 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K Q J
 ♥ Q 7 2
 ♦ 10 9 6
 ♣ J 7 4

♠ 10 6 2
 ♥ J 10 9 5
 ♦ 8 2
 ♣ 9 8 3 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ A

you know that East is going to over-ruff. So don't ruff it, discard dummy's ♣6 instead. Later you can ruff your ♣ loser in dummy.

If you had ruffed, East would have over-ruffed. And you would still have a ♣ loser. You don't have to worry about a fourth ♦ lead because you can ruff in your hand higher than any card East might ruff with.

When responding to a takeout double use these guidelines:
 0-8 points: bid a suit cheaply
 9-11 points: bid a suit with a jump
 12 or more points: cue-bid the opponent's suit

With 13 points you cue-bid 2 ♦. Partner says 2 ♥.

You are forced to game, now you must find a suit. Partner suggested ♥s, you suggest ♠s. Partner agrees ♠s and bids the game.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads ♦ A, ♦ K, ♦ Q. East plays ♦ 8 then ♦ 2.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads ♦ A, ♦ K, ♦ Q. East plays ♦ 8 then ♦ 2.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

If you could ruff that ♦ then one of your ♦ losers would be eliminated - if East didn't over-ruff. But

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 8
♥ A 5
♦ Q 10 6 2
♣ Q 4 3

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ Q 8 6 4

♦ A K 7

♣ J 2



♠ 10 4

♥ K 9 7 2

♦ J 9 3

♣ 10 9 7 6

♠ A 6 2

♥ J 10 3

♦ 8 5 4

♣ A K 8 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

Lead: ♥2

You have 13 points so you will definitely open the bidding. You don't open with a 4-card Major and you don't open with a 2-card ♣ suit. So this is the one distribution where you open a 3-card ♦ suit. Partner responds 2♣ and

Be very careful! You are tempted to now bid 2♥ or 2♠. Don't give in to the temptation. That would be a **REVERSE** - bidding a second, higher-ranking suit at the 2-level. You should have at least 16 points to reverse. Besides, if you trust partner you don't need to bid either of those suits anyway. If he had a 4-card Major he probably would have shown it on his first bid. No, your next bid is clearly 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥2, West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. East takes the ♥K and plays the ♥7.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥2, West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥5. East takes the ♥K and plays the ♥7.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

You are glad the defense started with ♥s, that was a suit you would have had to play yourself. You need one more winner and your first thought may be that the ♠s are going to have to split 3-3. However, that happens only about 40% of the time so you keep looking. There is one more card that might be valuable, the ♣J. If West holds the ♣Q then you can make a trick out of the ♣J.

You are already in dummy with the ♥J so you lead a small ♣. If West plays low you will play the ♣J which will hold the trick and become your 9th winner. If West plays his ♣Q you will have the ♣J for your 9th winner later.

And if West doesn't have the ♣Q at all? then you **STILL** have the possibility of a 3-3 ♠ split.

As you see, this time the ♠s didn't split so you had to make the ♣J to succeed.

Board 4

West Deals

None Vul

♠ —
 ♥ A K Q 10 3
 ♦ 9 6 4 2
 ♣ 10 6 3 2

♠ Q J 10 8 2

♥ 9 6 5

♦ Q 10

♣ Q 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7

♥ J 7 4

♦ A 7 5 3

♣ J 9 8 5

♠ A 9 6 5 4 3

♥ 8 2

♦ K J 8

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
2 ♥	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ A			

You open 1 ♠. West overcalls 2 ♥ and partner bids 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ Q.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

You have already lost the 2 ♥s and you will definitely lose the ♦. So you cannot lose a ♠ as well. When you have 11 cards in a suit missing the King, the recommended play is to play for the drop. But the recommended play shouldn't be used on this hand because you know that East has the ♠ K. How do you know this? Because West has turned up with 10 points in ♥s, (the A K Q and a fifth one). If he held the ♠ K as well he would have had 13 points and a good suit and would have opened he bidding. But he didn't open, so he doesn't have the ♠ K.

Ruff the ♥. Play the ♦ 8 to dummy's ♦ 10. If East takes the ♦ A win his return and enter dummy with the ♦ Q. When in dummy lead the ♠ Q and finesse East out of his ♠ K.

You have to listen to the bidding and draw conclusions from what is bid - and not bid. Because he passed originally you could figure out that West could not hold the ♠ K. Or, if you had needed to know, he could also not have had the ♦ A.